



MONTHLY UPDATE

Chad: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · 41 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The month is a budget document and a set of foreign grants. The 2027 orientations [bar any ministry from building a system incompatible with the existing platforms and require nine state functions to interconnect on a single identifier](#), with the electronic visa and online business creation to become exclusive channels from 2027 “” commitments whose framing text the base does not hold. The expenditure chain [is already mandated through the integrated public financial management system from the 2026 budget](#), with exclusive electronic state payment deferred to 2027.

The money came from two directions. Chad and China [signed two grant agreements totalling 300 million yuan](#) for infrastructure and digital transformation, and the Chinese ambassador [announced 5,000 technology and artificial-intelligence scholarships](#); separately a development bank [signed the grant agreement for the first phase of a business-climate and public-administration modernisation programme](#). On the other side of the ledger, the media regulator [suspended examination of applications to create online newspapers until further notice](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The policy movement of the window is advice rather than instrument. The economic, social, cultural and environmental council [closed a plenary session running 5 to 19 August on the public administration facing the digital transition, and adopted recommendations calling for an affirmed national digitalisation policy of wider scope, a durable national financing mechanism for the sector, adequate power supply, stronger public-agent skills and public-private partnerships](#). What the list describes is a stack the base can confirm is missing at almost every layer — which is why the recommendations read as a gap analysis. Nothing binds government to act on them and no response is on record.

Legislation and regulation

Chad's digital statutes entered the base this month by being listed, not by being made. The regulator's register [names the 2015 laws on cybersecurity, electronic transactions and personal data protection as the laws it works under](#) and links the text of none; the statistics institute [names Loi n. 026/PR/2019 and four decrees](#).

On payments there is nothing national to name at all: the central bank's register [gives the regional payment systems regulation of December 2016 as the instrument in force](#). A payments law that is regional and a practice that runs on conventions with four operators leave no statute a citizen can be pointed to.

Regional collaboration

The telecommunications minister [received an Azerbaijani delegation in N'Djamena to explore e-government cooperation](#). Nothing is agreed, and no memorandum, scope or value is on file.

Standards

The standards agency published its first adoptions: [the quality management systems committee adopted ten international standards as draft Chadian norms on 5 August 2026, with sessions of the electrotechnical and petroleum products committees either side of it](#). It is the first movement the base holds against a mandate standing since 2014.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

On 4 August the Haute autorité des médias et de l'audiovisuel [announced](#) that it suspends, "jusqu'à nouvel ordre", examination of applications to create online newspapers. The regulator presented the freeze as implementation of its 2026–2028 three-year strategic plan, one axis of which is to clean up the profession and better address "information disorder", and said it would study new arrangements for governing online newspapers with all stakeholders. The communiqué carried no date of its own, set no end date, no published criteria and no transitional treatment for applications already filed, so the outlets already licensed become a closed list for the duration.

A [national internet governance forum devoted to artificial intelligence is in preparation](#), with no date, venue or agenda yet announced.

Finance

New investments

The digital transformation project [shows US\\$12,220,932 disbursed and three thousand electronic payment terminals handed to the finance ministry](#), with about 500 unserved localities named as the outstanding challenge. Its envelope is [carried as FCFA 76.45bn in one source and US\\$92.2m in another](#) — the first close to total project cost, the second to the grant alone — and no source reconciles them. A [further programme of about FCFA 8bn sits at pipeline stage](#), 90 per cent externally committed with a closing date of 31 January 2029, covering electronic tax, standardised electronic invoicing, customs upgrades, tax teleservice centres and one-stop-shop interconnection. It is an aid-transparency record, not a signed instrument.

The fund's own appraisal report now settles the amount the base could not reconcile: the [grant is UA 9.52m against a phase-one total cost of UA 10.535m](#), so the FCFA figure the base had been carrying was a reporting outlet's conversion, and the gap between the two is the rest of the financing plan rather than a discrepancy.

ICT Infrastructure

Energy

The grid the digital estate sits on went backwards. After a fire at the Farcha thermal plant in late July, [load-shedding in parts of N'Djamena had run close to a month by 20 August, the utility saying the burnt sets need new equipment and giving no date](#). The data centre awaiting certification and the government network both sit on that supply, and no power arrangement for either is held.

Cybersecurity

The window's one cyber measure is a loss figure, and it comes from research rather than from the state. A comparative study of online job scams [puts the average loss for a Chadian victim at 58,000 FCFA per incident, against 132,000 FCFA in Cameroon](#), and finds the Chadian cases to be predominantly localised SMS and voice phishing — 70% of respondents — where the Cameroonian pattern is WhatsApp-based social engineering linked to Nigerian networks. It is a survey of respondents rather than a reported-crime series, and neither a sample size nor a national loss total is carried in the record held. Chad has no computer emergency response team and no adopted cybersecurity strategy, so there is nothing on the state's side of this to compare it against.

DPI

Data Exchange

The 2027 budget orientations [prohibit any ministry putting in place a computer system incompatible with the existing platforms](#), and require tax, customs, treasury, budget, accounting, cadastre, identity, state property and land registry to interconnect on a single identifier. It is the strongest interoperability commitment this ledger carries, and the base holds none of the framing text: no cost, phasing or implementing agency is named.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity agency stated its own position for the first time in the base, [describing a system that assigns every enrolled individual a unique national identification number across 29 centres](#). What it does not give is a number: no enrolment total and no coverage rate, so the three per cent holding a card at appraisal in 2023 has no successor.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 24 July the Ministry of Finance took delivery of [3,000 smart electronic payment terminals](#) supplied under the World Bank-financed Projet d'appui à la transformation numérique, intended to digitise collection of public revenue; the ministry named no deployment schedule, target sites or per-agency allocation.

The 2027 budget orientations, reported 4 August, [restate](#) the mandate for exclusive electronic payment of state obligations — bank or mobile transfer only, against a standardised electronic invoice — for a start of 1 January 2027. The same regime had already been [mandated for budget year 2026](#) — exclusively bank or mobile payments, cash and cheques out; nothing in the base shows that 2026 mandate operating, so the restatement is a year's slip rather than a new commitment. Chad had already launched the standardised electronic invoice itself, among the first CEMAC states to do so, under the 2026 budget; the August orientations move only the exclusivity date.

On 29 July, at Douala, the BEAC and GIMAC [launched the CEMAC's interoperable QR-code payment standard](#), in force under a monetary-union regulation of 8 April 2026 across all six member states including Chad and letting any bank, mobile-money or microfinance account settle a purchase at any merchant's code, routed and settled through the regional switch. No Chadian bank, wallet or merchant deployment is on record: Chad is covered by the regulation rather than shown live.

The electronic money market has more providers and no newer numbers. [Two further providers have joined the two mobile operators' services, and users report fees they consider high, with competition presented as the hope rather than the position, against 160,000 to 240,000 accounts over 2020 to 2022](#). No current account count, transaction volume, tariff schedule or regulator series is published, so the market's growth is described and not measured.

Registries

Civil registration is where Chad's month has both its clearest instrument and its largest gap. [48.33 per cent of new births are registered within the three-month legal deadline](#), with about 2.95m under-fives undeclared and 829,000 pupils in school with no document attesting their legal existence. Against that a [six-month campaign to December targets at least a million children from four months to seventeen years across twelve provinces](#), by household enumeration and a schools drive, with community teams using smartphones feeding the biometric register; no enrolment achieved so far is reported, and one account puts the household component in twelve provinces while another says every province. It runs inside a [moratorium signed on 2 February suspending court fees for supplementary birth judgments for that age range until 2030](#) — a four-year legal window around a six-month campaign — whose own text is not held. The civil-registration application has been [deployed since 2021 with no coverage, site count or throughput figure published](#), and new monthly *paper* collection forms were introduced in August to improve transmission of birth, marriage and death data to the centre.

A register of a different kind opened. The youth and sports ministry [launched MJS CONNECT in N'Djamena on 4 September to register sports federations, youth associations and movements and build a national directory of them, letting registered associations enrol, hold a digital space and file administrative formalities online, and recording who is active, in what field and where](#), with performance indicators intended to inform how the ministry allocates resources. No registration count, cost, vendor or data-protection provision is published.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The 2027 budget orientations carry three govtech commitments and one system already running. From 2027 the [electronic visa is to be the exclusive channel for application, payment, processing and issue, and business creation fully online end to end](#) — exclusivity stated with no fallback channel, and the base holding no statement on whether an electronic visa operates today. The same text extends the integrated public financial management system, already the mandated expenditure environment, to all institutions, local authorities, public establishments, projects and diplomatic missions, with no coverage figure or count of entities live. Separately a [freight bureau enrolment platform went live for Chadian hauliers working in Cameroon](#), presented at Douala, with no services list, deadline, fee schedule or enrolment target stated.

The platform the state already uses to watch itself surfaced on 7 August, when the Prime Minister [received the two-year delivery report on the president's twelve-project programme, tracked through Guidam, the government's sovereign digital data platform](#), ahead of a cabinet seminar to align implementation reporting. Neither the report nor any description of the platform's custodian, supplier, hosting or public accessibility is held.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

[Solar-powered telemedicine kiosks](#) are helping rural patients overcome distance to care. No kiosk count, operator, consultation volume or funding source is on file.

Technology

AI

The base holds its first record of an artificial-intelligence strategy for Chad: a [consultancy is being recruited to draft a National Digital Transformation and Artificial Intelligence Strategy for 2026 to 2031](#). The row that stood as not held is settled to that extent and no further; there is no draft, adoption route or delivery date.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute set out what it publishes and on what terms: [five channels, from an Open Data Portal to a development-plan indicator tracker](#), against an archive policy [barring transmission of microdata without prior written agreement](#). The pipes are built and the licence is what is missing.

Open data

Publication and access moved in opposite directions. The statistics archive [bars redistribution of microdata without written consent](#), which settles whether Chadian public data is open: it is published and it is not open. On the access side the media regulator [suspended applications to create online newspapers until further notice](#), against a record holding no freedom of information law at all.

Geopolitics

China activities

The financing that did arrive in the window came from one partner. Chad and China [signed two grant agreements totalling 300 million yuan, in tranches of 100 million and 200 million that the minister of state called immediately mobilisable](#), for infrastructure and social development with digital technologies supported alongside; and earlier in the week the Chinese ambassador [announced 5,000 scholarships in technology and artificial intelligence](#). Neither carries a project list, a digital allocation or a timetable, and the local-currency equivalents in circulation differ between outlets on their own conversion dates.

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